exponents or women champions. Many Vidushis of India have contributed in composing the verses of the Vedas. Lopamudra, Gargi, Maitreyee … it's a long list of names. Today, we talk about 'Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao', 'save the girl child, educate her'. But centuries ago, it has been mentioned in our ancient texts, in the Skand Puran:

Dashputra-samakanya, dashputran pravdharyan
Yat falam labhte marya, tata, labhyam kanyakaikeya

This means, a daughter is the equivalent of ten sons. The 'Punya' that you earn through ten sons amounts to the same earned through just one daughter. This underscores the importance that has been given to women in our society. And that is why, in our society, women have been accorded the status of 'Shakti'. This woman power binds closely together society as a whole, the family as a whole, on the axis of unity & oneness. Be it the erudition of the Vidushis of the Vedic Period … Lopamudra, Gargi, Maitreyee; be it the learning & devotion of Akka Mahadevi or Meerabai, be it the governance of Ahilyabai Holkar or the valour of Rani Lakshmibai, woman power has always inspired us. They have always brought glory to the Nation.

Equally, Modi has been criticised for largely speaking of women in relational terms (sisters, mothers, daughters).[70] Be that as it may, the gender focus in his messaging is clear.

Step 2: The BJP Fielded More Women Candidates, Gave Women Higher Share in Party Leadership and Central Government than Other Parties Did

Between 2004 and 2019, the BJP became far more accommodative of women candidates than it had ever been before. Until the early 2000s, it had a low representation rate for women it fielded for the Lok Sabha: only 8.2 per cent in 2004. The thirty women candidates fielded by the party that year were substantially lower than the